

PROPOSAL · 5 SERIES (G60)

Simplify the iDrive controls

How the nine evidence-backed customer segments would react — simulated verdicts over 29 cited pieces of BMW's own evidence.

Net verdict	**Lean positive**	6 segments more likely · 0 less · 1 no effect · 2 insufficient
Evidence cited	**29**	24 feedback comments · 5 study cells · scope: G60 feedback from US/CA (BEV); study: US
G60 market 2025	**296,000 units**	2030 forecast 316,000 units (EU/US/CN/RoW)

Cover visual: generated per proposal (direction brief → gpt-6-luna authored the prompt → gpt-image-2.5-flare). All figures set by the document, never by the image.

Run 25edcfdf · generated 2026-10-11 · simulated persona verdicts, not customer votes

How each segment would react

Bars on a shared 5-point scale (left = less likely, right = more likely). A tick means the model found too little evidence to take a position.



Dana
Tech frustrated · Digital-Friction BEV convert

Slightly more likely



Elena
Comfort first · Comfort-requester premium family

Slightly more likely



Jiwon
Waiting skeptic · Quality-first ICE skeptic

Slightly more likely



Soren
Anxious pioneer · Electrified driving-culture buyer

Slightly more likely



Claire
Quiet majority · After-sales pragmatist

Slightly more likely



Anja
Legacy driver · ICE digital-nostalgic

Slightly more likely



Marcus
Status driven · Dynamics-loyalist ICE

No effect



Wei
Status buyer · Status connector

Insufficient evidence



Mei
Cost calculator · Efficiency family planner

Insufficient evidence

Verdicts are a model-based interpretation of the evidence (Simulated provenance). The model only saw the evidence listed per segment and every citation was server-checked against it.

Why the model called it this way

“I’d welcome simpler iDrive controls if they make common tasks easier to find and operate. I also value the touchscreen, so simplification should not make it less useful.”
— Dana (Tech frustrated) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-0310, G60-0224, G60-1228, G60-2937, G60-1266, STUDY-11, G60-0160, G60-0177, STUDY-5, STUDY-9

“I’d welcome iDrive controls that are simpler and less distracting to use; the current system can feel confusing. [G60-0190] [G60-0271]”
— Elena (Comfort first) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-0190, G60-0271, G60-2937, G60-0160, G60-0369

“I’d be somewhat more receptive if simplification makes the interface more intuitive and less touch-dependent. Driving dynamics remain my main priority.”
— Jiwon (Waiting skeptic) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-2409, G60-3649

“I’d be more receptive if simplification means fewer taps and less screen-diving while driving. The driving feel is already a strength, so the controls should make it easier to stay focused on driving.”
— Soren (Anxious pioneer) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-1746, G60-1848, STUDY-1, STUDY-2, G60-2254

“I’d be somewhat more inclined to favor a 5 Series with simpler iDrive controls if it makes everyday functions easier to find and use. Too many submenus and screen use that feels distracting or risky are practical hassles.”
— Claire (Quiet majority) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-0298, G60-0798, G60-1746, G60-1835, G60-1848, STUDY-1, STUDY-2, G60-1479

“I’d be more open to iDrive if it felt less like a system I have to manage: the touchscreen took time to learn and can be distracting. Still, I’m happy with it now that I’ve got used to it.”
— Anja (Legacy driver) · Slightly more likely · cited: G60-0843, G60-1835, STUDY-1, STUDY-2, G60-1835

“I value the car’s dynamics. Simpler access to controls would be welcome, but it is not a major factor for me.”
— Marcus (Status driven) · No effect · cited: G60-0248, G60-0271, G60-1034, G60-0105, G60-0574

“Comfort matters to us, but the available results don’t show whether simplifying iDrive would improve the experience.”
— Wei (Status buyer) · Insufficient evidence · cited: STUDY-1, STUDY-2

“I can’t tell whether simplifying iDrive would matter to me. The study rates the current controls and information system as easy to use, but doesn’t show how this segment would react to simplifying them.”
— Mei (Cost calculator) · Insufficient evidence · cited: STUDY-1, STUDY-2

What the evidence says

Every claim below carries its source ID — comments are verbatim from BMW feedback; study cells cite their exact sheet cell.

Operation of heater/ AC controls — top2box 0.289 (US G60)
STUDY-1 · study cell: COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 426-432 col C

Operation of heater/ AC controls — top2box 0.321 (US G70)
STUDY-2 · study cell: COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 426-432 col D

“Customer stated she is really enjoying the screen interface.”
G60-0105 · US · ICE — — supports none · argues against Marcus

“Customer stated the vehicle's touchscreen is excellent.”
G60-0160 · US · BEVE — — supports none · argues against Dana, Elena

“Customer commented that they enjoy the infotainment.”
G60-0177 · US · BEVE — — supports none · argues against Dana

“the car itself is great. the idrive system is a bit confusing to use. having had seven bmws before, i really miss the old mechanical buttons.”
G60-0190 · US · PHEV — supports Elena

“Customer stated it is annoying that they can no longer view the odometer using the BC button on the stalk and must go through the main screen instead. Writer advised that by scrolling through the instrument cluster display options, one of the views shows the odometer. Customer confirmed.”
G60-0224 · US · BEVE — supports Dana

“Customer reported that the screen layout is not very intuitive for accessing some functions, even though this is around their eighth or ninth BMW. Customer noted there are numerous manual actions required and that the system relies a lot on touchscreen interaction. Customer stated a BMW genius explained that voice commands are available, but Customer prefers more click-type controls or simpler access instead of going through several layers of menus on the display. Customer commented there are many technical features in the car and feels the system is less intuitive than prior BMW vehicles they have owned. Writer acknowledged the comments and thanked the Customer for providing their experience.”
G60-0248 · US · ICE — supports Marcus

“Customer mentioned the touchscreen controls for airflow are too distracting while driving and said she would prefer physical knobs to set the vent speed manually. Writer advised using the "Hey BMW" voice assistant for climate adjustments. Customer said she had noticed that feature but was not aware it could handle that function.”
G60-0271 · US · ICE — supports Elena, Marcus

“im generally very happy, but in winter the electric range maybe isnt the greatest. some options are hard to find again in the menus.”
G60-0298 · SE · PHEV — supports Claire

“build quality and ride are good. infotainment really ought to be more intuitive.”
G60-0310 · US · BEVE — supports Dana

“Customer stated he is pleased with how the touchscreen works and is also happy with the size of the screen.”
G60-0369 · US · ICE — — supports none · argues against Elena

“Customer stated he is pleased with the new design and layout of the iDrive console in the vehicle.”
G60-0574 · US · ICE — — supports none · argues against Marcus

“the car itself is very good but the info system really leaves a lot to be desired, with way too many submenus. some of the materials feel a bit questionable for such a nice car.”
G60-0798 · SE · PHEV — supports Claire

“i still like my old 520 more, this one feels over-regulated. the speed warning gets on my nerves and there are a bunch of privacy data settings you have to switch off. the car also starts braking the moment you take your foot off the accelerator, so you have to press the pedal again just to stop it from slowing down. that behavior is really annoying, and it feels like i'm always battling the computer system instead of simply enjoying the drive.”
G60-0843 · GB · ICE — supports Anja

“Customer stated he would like to see more physical controls return in the vehicles. Customer mentioned he understands manufacturers are moving toward more digital layouts, but he thinks it would be nice to have a good mix of analog and digital controls. Custmoer emphasized this preference.”
G60-1034 · US · ICE — supports Marcus

“If there was one comment (positive or negative) about your new vehicle that you would allow us to share with your vehicle's manufacturer, what would you want to say to them? : "Please put physical buttons back in, at least for a few of the functions!"”
G60-1228 · US · BEVE — supports Dana

“Customer mentioned he would prefer having more physical knobs for the climate control functions, rather than needing to navigate through the screen for those adjustments.”
G60-1266 · US · BEVE — supports Dana

“excellent comfort and road holding. the battery manages around 9 miles. great display and system, very satisfied overall - min 5; e 5serie■”
G60-1479 · SE · PHEV — — supports none · argues against Claire

“it is insanely expensive, so most of my friends and family would never even think about owning one. the car itself is great, but the mileage is nowhere near what is advertised, especially when you only charge the battery to 80%. with so few physical buttons, poking around the screen to change things can feel risky while driving. sure, you can adjust stuff with voice control or from the steering wheel, but sometimes a plain old button is just much easier.”
G60-1746 · GB · BEVE — supports Claire, Soren

“i have been driving 5series for more than 20 years and i love the brand. this 5 is a delight to drive and now that i have got used to the touch screen i am very happy with it. the touch screen did take quite a while to get used to and i am still geting there. at times i find it distracting when i am driving but the verbal commands work well. the 5 is always a joy to drive.”
G60-1835 · GB · ICE — supports Anja, Claire · argues against Anja

“for me the car feels a bit oversized, but other than that it really is excellent. the one downside is the software, which is pretty sluggish and makes you tap several times for a lot of functions.”
G60-1848 · GB · BEVE — supports Claire, Soren

“overall, the cars are very high quality, both in materials and in how they are put together, and also when it comes to driving feel and comfort. the software is actually really good, but there is a major but. it is almost ridiculous that you cant "talk" danish to the car. danish voice control exists even in cheap little pispotters. it comes across a bit arrogant that danish has been left out for years. that really has to be fixed if the total experience is going to feel properly high quality.”
G60-2254 · DK · BEVE — — supports none · argues against Soren

“the exterior styling is good, including the iconic glow lights and the headlamps. i feel the adas works better than many other systems. however, the id8.5 interface is not very intuitive, and i would prefer if the home screen widgets were improved so users could edit them. overall it seems finished at the level of a domestic mid-size car.”
G60-2409 · KR · ICE — supports Jiwon

“Need real buttons for climate and audio, there are way too many touchscreen controls.. That is the one thing could be most improved about the interior of my vehicle.”
G60-2937 · US · BEVE — supports Dana, Elena

“it's quiet, comfortable and rides well. i'm slightly disappointed that every menu has to be used via touch controls only.”
G60-3649 · KR · PHEV — supports Jiwon

Study context cited by the segments

ID	Attribute	Metric	Value	Market	Source cell
STUDY-1	Operation of heater/ AC controls	top2box	0.289	US	COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 426-432 col C
STUDY-2	Operation of heater/ AC controls	top2box	0.321	US	COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 426-432 col D
STUDY-5	Intuitiveness of controls	top2box	0.422	US	COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 480-486 col C
STUDY-9	Ease of reading and using screen interface	top2box	0.498	US	COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 831-837 col C
STUDY-11	Menu structure of infotainment system	top2box	0.357	US	COMPUTED from US_2025 rows 858-864 col C

Assumptions (forward-looking — not evidence)

- Dana: The proposed simplification improves menu and control usability without reducing valued touchscreen functionality.
- Dana: This segment's stated digital-friction focus applies to its reaction to the successor's iDrive.
- Marcus: The segment's high dynamics-topic share means control simplification is not a major purchase or satisfaction driver for it.
- Elena: The change makes common controls easier to use without removing functions this segment values.
- Elena: Usability improvements matter to this comfort-focused segment even though segment-specific evidence is not provided.
- Jiwon: Simplification improves intuitiveness or reduces reliance on touch controls.
- Jiwon: The segment gives some weight to usability despite its strong dynamics focus.
- Soren: The change makes common functions simpler to operate while driving, rather than merely reducing controls.
- Soren: The Nordic-weighted EU evidence is directionally relevant to EU BEV buyers.
- Claire: The simplification makes frequently used functions easier to access without removing useful capabilities.
- Anja: The successor's simplification reduces interaction friction without removing useful functions.

Appendix A — full citation map

One row per cited ID per segment. Full verbatim text lives in Supabase (feedback_comment.comment_id / study_metric.source_cell); open the run in Backseat → click the segment → evidence drawer for the raw source.

ID	Type	For/Against	Segments	Text / cell (truncated)
G60-0105	comment	against	Marcus	Customer stated she is really enjoying the screen interface.…
G60-0160	comment	against	Dana, Elena	Customer stated the vehicle's touchscreen is excellent.…
G60-0177	comment	against	Dana	Customer commented that they enjoy the infotainment.…
G60-0190	comment	supports	Elena	the car itself is great. the idrive system is a bit confusing to use. having had seven bmws before, i really m…
G60-0224	comment	supports	Dana	Customer stated it is annoying that they can no longer view the odometer using the BC button on the stalk and …
G60-0248	comment	supports	Marcus	Customer reported that the screen layout is not very intuitive for accessing some functions, even though this …
G60-0271	comment	supports	Elena, Marcus	Customer mentioned the touchscreen controls for airflow are too distracting while driving and said she would p…
G60-0298	comment	supports	Claire	im generally very happy, but in winter the electric range maybe isnt the greatest. some options are hard to fi…
G60-0310	comment	supports	Dana	build quality and ride are good. infotainment really ought to be more intuitive.…
G60-0369	comment	against	Elena	Customer stated he is pleased with how the touchscreen works and is also happy with the size of the screen.…
G60-0574	comment	against	Marcus	Customer stated he is pleased with the new design and layout of the iDrive console in the vehicle.…
G60-0798	comment	supports	Claire	the car itself is very good but the info system really leaves a lot to be desired, with way too many submenus.…
G60-0843	comment	supports	Anja	i still like my old 520 more, this one feels over-regulated. the speed warning gets on my nerves and there are…
G60-1034	comment	supports	Marcus	Customer stated he would like to see more physical controls return in the vehicles. Customer mentioned he unde…
G60-1228	comment	supports	Dana	If there was one comment (positive or negative) about your new vehicle that you would allow us to share with y…
G60-1266	comment	supports	Dana	Customer mentioned he would prefer having more physical knobs for the climate control functions, rather than n…
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G60-1746	comment	supports	Claire, Soren	it is insanely expensive, so most of my friends and family would never even think about owning one. the car it…
G60-1835	comment	both	Anja, Claire	i have been driving 5series for more than 20 years and i love the brand. this 5 is a delight to drive and now …
G60-1848	comment	supports	Claire, Soren	for me the car feels a bit oversized, but other than that it really is excellent. the one downside is the soft…
G60-2254	comment	against	Soren	overall, the cars are very high quality, both in materials and in how they are put together, and also when it …

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G60-3649	comment	supports	Jiwon	it's quiet, comfortable and rides well. i'm slightly disappointed that every menu has to be used via touch con…
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